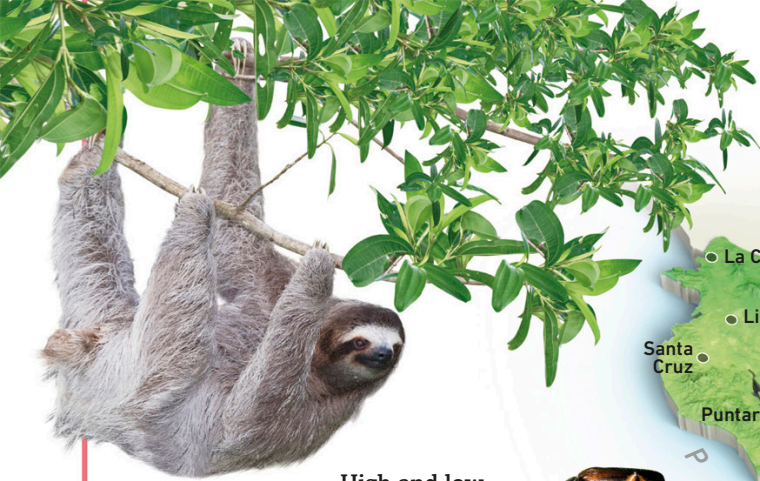




High and low
Slow-moving sloths live high in the treetops of Costa Rica, while beetles and other bugs scurry around the forest floor.

Costa Rica is rich in **animal life**—more than **half a million species** live in the nation's **cloud forests, rain forests, mangrove swamps, arid plains, and tropical waters. Wildlife is protected** in one-third of the country.



- 📏 19,730 sq miles (51,100 sq km)
- 👤 5 million
- ★ San José
- 🗣️ Spanish, other languages (+3)

Costa Rica



North America

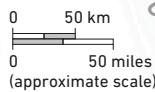


Boruca people
An indigenous Costa Rican tribe, the Boruca people are known for their skilled carving of traditional wooden devil masks.



Ometepe Island

The largest island in Lake Nicaragua, Ometepe has two volcanoes, one of which towers over the surrounding waters.



Dennis Martínez

One of Nicaragua's best-known athletes is Dennis Martínez, a pitcher in Major League Baseball from the 1970s to 1990s.

- 📏 50,336 sq miles (130,370 sq km)
- 👤 6.2 million
- ★ Managua
- 🗣️ Spanish, other languages (+2)



Nicaragua



Nicaraguan coffee
Coffee is one of the most important crops in Nicaragua, where trees grow best in the volcanic highland soils. The seeds of the ripe red fruits are dried and roasted to make coffee.



This Central American country has a **dramatic landscape of volcanoes and lakes. Lake Nicaragua**, which covers more than 3,000 sq miles (8,000 sq km), is the **largest**.